IT Security & Access Control Standard — 2026

Synthetic technical policy document with terminology overlap designed to challenge semantic retrieval.

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Identity and Access Management

Multi-Factor Authentication

MFA is mandatory for corporate email, VPN, cloud administration consoles, source-code repositories, and production dashboards. Approved factors include authenticator applications and hardware security keys.

Password Standard

Corporate passwords must contain at least 14 characters. Password reuse across corporate and personal services is prohibited. Passwords must not be stored in plain-text files or shared through chat.

Privileged Access

Production administrative access follows least-privilege principles. Privileged accounts should be separate from standard user accounts, and elevated access should be reviewed at least quarterly.

Access Reviews

Application owners must review active access permissions quarterly. Departing employees must have access revoked as part of the offboarding workflow.

Data Classification

Public

Information approved for unrestricted external distribution.

Internal

Business information intended for employees and approved contractors.

Confidential

Information whose unauthorized disclosure could create material business, contractual, or customer impact.

Restricted

Highly sensitive information requiring additional controls, including selected credentials, regulated records, and production secrets.

Secure Development

Dependency Management

Engineering teams must track third-party dependencies and remediate critical vulnerabilities according to the security team's severity-based service levels.

Secrets

API keys, database passwords, private certificates, and tokens must be stored in an approved secrets-management system. Secrets must not be committed to source-control repositories.

Code Review

Changes to production-bound services require peer review. Security-sensitive changes may require additional approval from an application security reviewer.

Logging

Production services should log authentication events, authorization failures, important administrative actions, and security-relevant configuration changes without exposing secret values.

Incident Response

Severity 1

A confirmed or strongly suspected compromise of production credentials, sensitive customer data, or critical infrastructure is treated as a Severity 1 incident.

Initial Response

The incident responder should preserve relevant evidence, contain active threats, notify the security response channel, and document the incident timeline.

Credential Compromise

Potentially compromised credentials should be revoked or rotated promptly. The affected service owner must validate dependent integrations after rotation.

Post-Incident Review

Significant incidents require a documented review covering root cause, impact, containment, recovery, and preventive actions.

Cloud and Network Controls

Production Access

Production access should originate from approved identity providers and managed devices. Administrative access from unmanaged personal devices is prohibited unless an explicitly approved emergency procedure applies.

Encryption

Sensitive data should be encrypted in transit using modern TLS configurations and encrypted at rest using approved cloud or enterprise key-management controls.

Backups

Critical production data must have scheduled backups. Backup restoration tests should be performed periodically to validate recoverability.